RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

18 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 1:53 PM, Sunday 18 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 366 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 43 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,631 minutes at 2:00 PM; Dammam moving with 3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 9,631 minutes at 2:00 PM; GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 366 flights cancelled for Sunday so far (63% of scheduled).
- Civil Defense alerts in Najran and As Sulayyil at 1:37 PM, all-clears by 1:41 PM; no interception or damage officially reported.
- Coalition says a National Guard helicopter crashed in Najran from a technical fault, killing two officers; Houthis claim they shot it down.
- Dammam airport moving: 3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour, latest takeoff Air Arabia 4P3 to Jeddah at 1:42 PM and landing flyadeal F3458 from Bisha at 1:46 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9624 min).

366	0/0	3
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

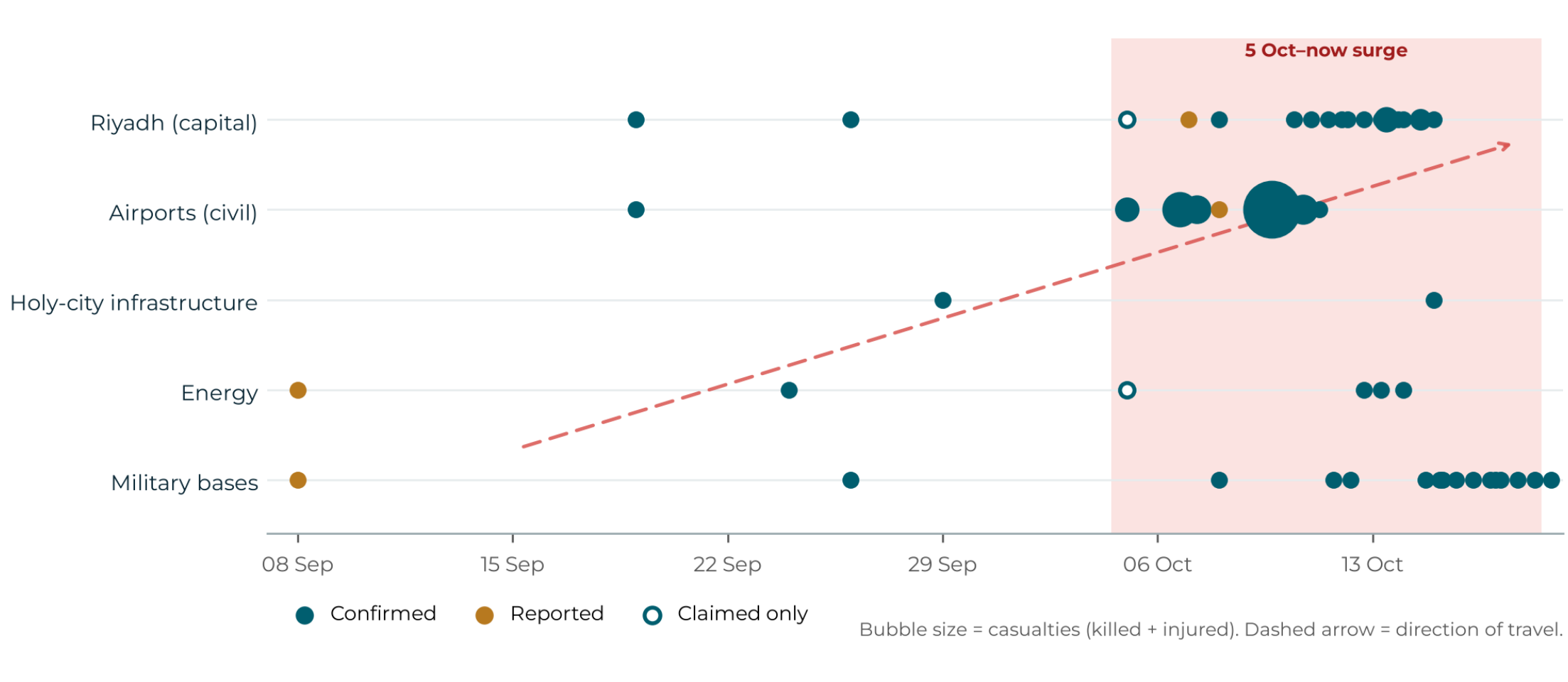
3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

43	3/3	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (9,511 min at 12:00 PM); no GACA reopening announcement
- Riyadh airport's account told passengers at 11:02 and 11:07 AM to follow official authorities and contact their airline
- Bahrain's foreign minister condemned continued Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and its airports at the GCC meeting in Manama (11:50 AM)
- Dammam landings only: 3 landings, no takeoff in the last hour; last takeoff flyadeal F3304 at 10:43 AM
- No new official attack or interception report since 3:16 AM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 18 OCT



50 sourced events since 8 September (44 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed in Riyadh region (18 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA / Al Ekhbariya; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 1:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED ALERT **1:37 PM AST · Najran**

Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for Najran City to warn of a potential danger. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALERT **1:38 PM AST · As Sulayyil**

Civil Defense early-warning alert issued for As Sulayyil Governorate to warn of a danger. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **1:39 PM AST · Najran**

Civil Defense all-clear for Najran City; danger passed. Saudi Civil Defense

CONFIRMED ALL-CLEAR **1:41 PM AST · As Sulayyil**

Civil Defense all-clear for As Sulayyil Governorate; danger passed. Saudi Civil Defense

Last 24 hours: Interceptions 5, alerts 6, all-clears 6, casualty reports 1.

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh airport still halted; brief Civil Defense alerts in Najran and As Sulayyil; helicopter crash in Najran kills two officers

Checked at 1:55 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

UNVERIFIED **Single social account reports explosions at the As Sulayyil missile base; no official confirmation**

WorldConflict_X (@WorldConflict_X) · **1:49 PM** · posted 1:49 PM AST Sun 18 Oct, citing unverified reports; checked 1:55 PM

A conflict-news account on X says explosions were reported inside the Saudi strategic missile base at As Sulayyil, citing unverified reports. No official source has confirmed it; Civil Defense declared the danger over in As Sulayyil at 1:41 PM.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense early-warning alerts in Najran and As Sulayyil, then all-clears within minutes**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **1:41 PM** · alerts published 1:37 PM (Najran) and 1:38 PM (As Sulayyil), all-clears 1:39 PM and 1:41 PM AST Sun 18 Oct (official account); also Al Ekhbariya and Arab News; checked 1:55 PM

The National Early Warning Platform issued danger alerts for Najran City at 1:37 PM and As Sulayyil Governorate at 1:38 PM. Civil Defense said the danger had passed in Najran at 1:39 PM and in As Sulayyil at 1:41 PM. No interception, debris or casualties have been officially reported.

CONFIRMED **Bahrain's foreign minister condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and its airports, backs its right to self-defence**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:17 PM** · published 11:46 AM to 1:17 PM AST Sun 18 Oct at the GCC ministerial meeting and the GCC-Russia strategic dialogue (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 1:55 PM

Bahrain's foreign minister renewed his condemnation of Houthi attacks on the Kingdom, its civilian sites and civil airports, said the Gulf states stand as one with Saudi Arabia and back its right to self-defence, and condemned the disruption of shipping in Hormuz and Bab el-Mandeb.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to check flight status with their airline and follow official authorities**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:49 PM** · replies posted 11:02 AM to 12:49 PM AST Sun 18 Oct to passengers asking whether flights have resumed, including for Tuesday 20 Oct; checked 12:58 PM

Riyadh airport's official account is answering passengers who ask whether flights are running, including on Tuesday 20 October, by telling them to contact their airline for flight status and to follow official authorities for airspace updates. It has not announced a reopening.

CONFIRMED **GCC Secretary-General condemns continued Houthi attacks on civilians, airports and energy sites in the Kingdom, and rejects Iran's targeting of Hormuz shipping**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv); Al Arabiya English · **12:02 PM** · published 11:56 AM to 12:02 PM AST Sun 18 Oct at the 168th GCC ministerial meeting in Manama (translated from Arabic); checked 12:58 PM

GCC Secretary-General Jasem AlBudaiwi said the GCC rejects the Houthi militia's continued targeting of civilians, airports and energy facilities in the Kingdom, calling it deliberate criminal behaviour that needs a firm international stance. He also rejected Iran's targeting of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz.

UNVERIFIED **The National reports Riyadh airport reopened Sunday, but many airlines keep Saudi suspensions**

The National; The New Arab · **10:53 AM** · published 10:53 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no GACA reopening statement found and the Flightradar24 board still shows no Riyadh movements; checked 11:56 AM; The New Arab reported the same at 1:45 PM; checked 1:55 PM

The National says King Khalid airport reopened on Sunday, but lists carriers still suspended: Etihad and flydubai to 19 October, Oman Air to 22 October, Air France and Air India to 24 October, SalamAir to 31 October, Cathay Pacific to 31 January 2027, and Qatar Airways with no date. The flight board does not yet show any Riyadh takeoff or landing.

UNVERIFIED **Ministry of Education keeps Riyadh and Diriyah schools on remote learning through 22 October**

The Gulf Bulletin (@thegulfbulletin), citing the Ministry of Education · **10:12 AM** · posted 10:12 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; ministry announcement made Saturday, not seen on the ministry's own channel; checked 10:55 AM

The Gulf Bulletin reports the Ministry of Education announced on Saturday that schools in Riyadh city and Diriyah Governorate will stay on remote learning through 22 October as a precaution, with lessons on the Madrasati platform.

CORROBORATED **Aviation accounts say the Riyadh closure notice expired, but arrivals and departures still need prior permission**

Trips N' Maps (@tripsNmapsX), FlightCore Info (@FlightCoreinfos), The Contrail · **8:37 AM** · first posted 7:10 AM, repeated by FlightCore Info at 8:37 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; no GACA statement; checked 9:00 AM

Two aviation-tracking accounts and The Contrail say the closure NOTAM for King Khalid International expired at midnight on 17 October, but new notices require prior permission for every arrival and departure and bar its use as an alternate. GACA has not announced a reopening, and the Flightradar24 board still shows no Riyadh movements.

CONFIRMED **Saudi National Guard helicopter crashes in Najran, killing two officers; Coalition cites a technical malfunction**

Saudi Press Agency (@Spa_Eng); Coalition spokesman · **7:02 AM** · SPA published 7:02 AM and 7:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct; also Al Arabiya English and Arab News; checked 1:55 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki al-Maliki said a National Guard AH-6i reconnaissance helicopter crashed inside Saudi territory in Najran due to a technical malfunction, killing its two officers. The Houthis have published footage they say shows it being shot down by a surface-to-air missile; that claim is not confirmed.

CONFIRMED **Philippines: first 34 Filipino workers from Riyadh due home on Monday as more await flights**

Philippine News Agency (@pnagovph) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Sun 18 Oct (Philippine government news agency); checked 9:00 AM

The Philippine News Agency says the first batch of 34 overseas Filipino workers from Riyadh is expected to arrive on Monday, with the government arranging repatriation of hundreds more.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (9624 min).

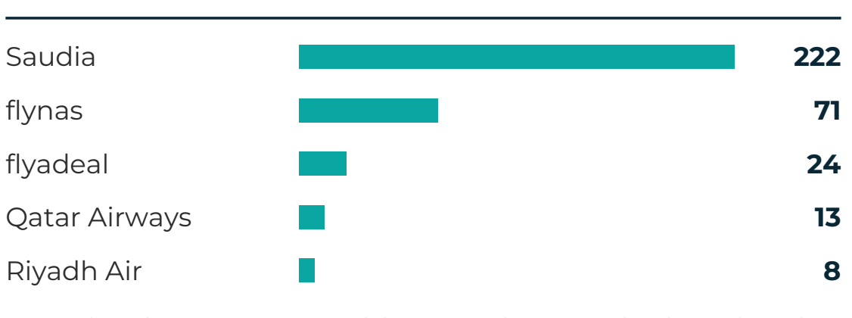
366	—	—	0	3
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
194 departures + 172 arrivals, 63% of 577 scheduled.	None on the board.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 1:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 366 at 1:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

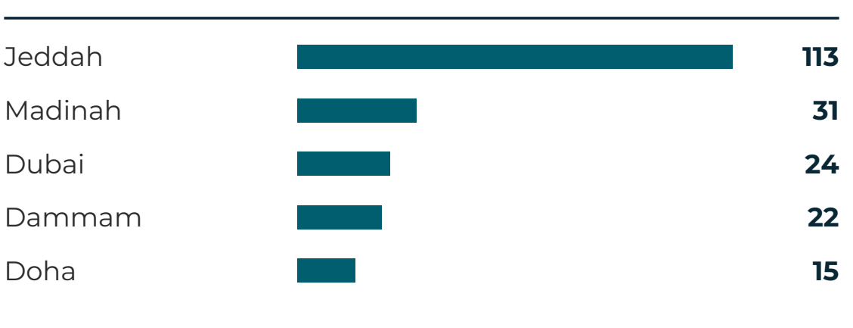
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**194**	**172**	**366**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**194 (63%)**	**172 (63%)**	**366**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**2 (1%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**2 (100%)**	**0 (0%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**186 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 168**	**0 of 108**	**0 of 276**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**3**	**3**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**19**	**38**	**57**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**18**	**23**	**41**	FR24 stats panel

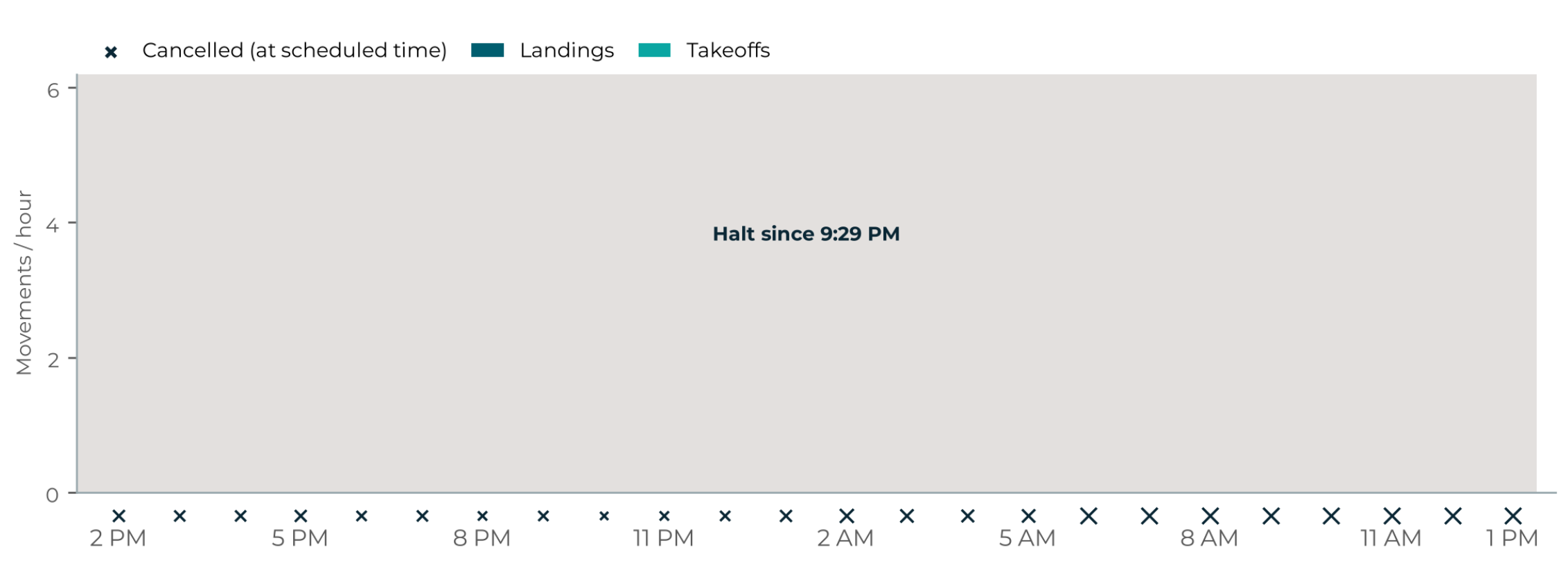
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



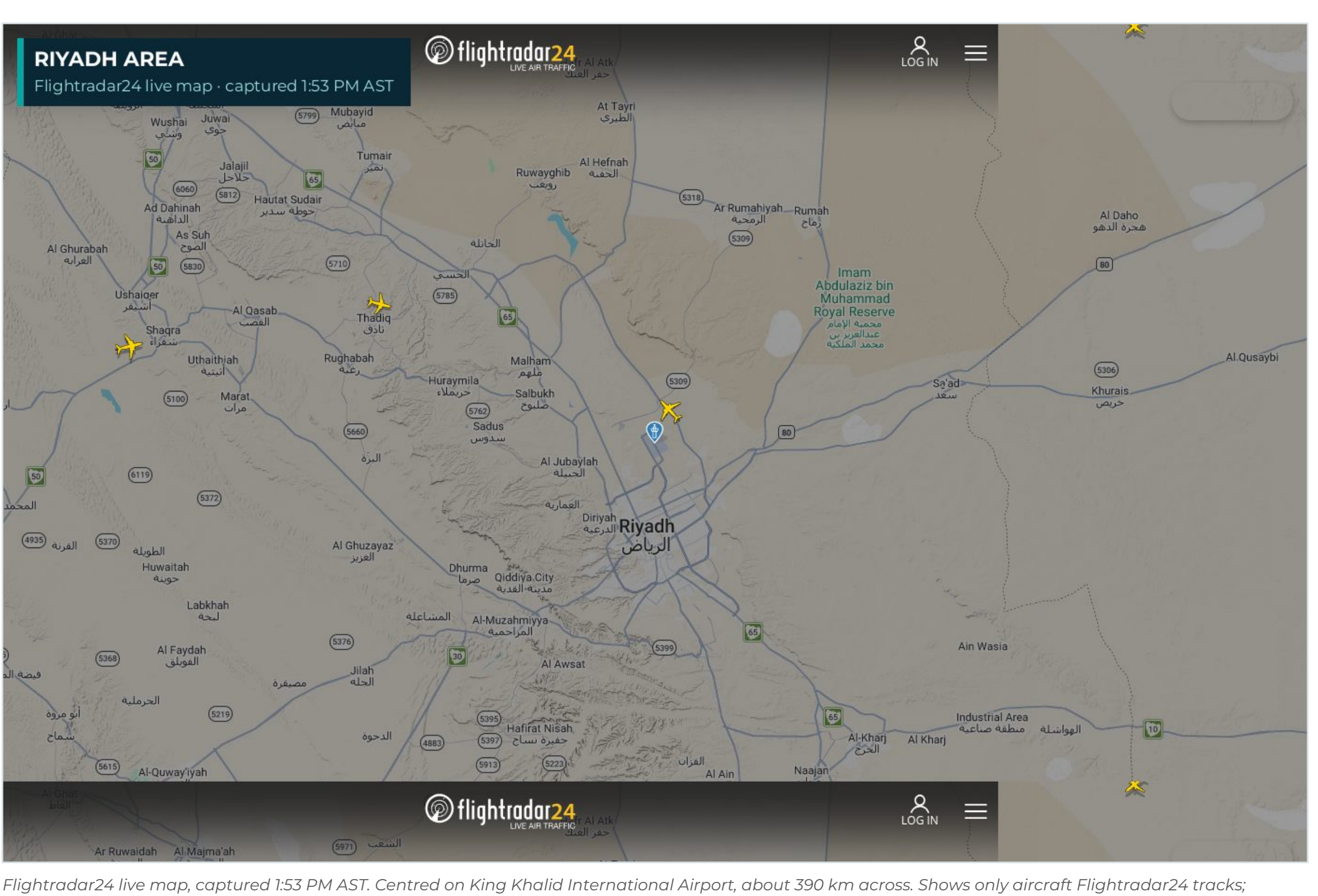
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 2:00 PM Saturday to 1:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's latest halt ran from 10:49 to 11:35 AM; takeoffs restarted with Gulf Air GF104 to Bahrain at 11:58 AM. Earlier Dammam halts in the window ran 5:09–6:01 PM, 9:42–11:11 PM, 12:17–1:05 AM, 1:15–2:04 AM, 2:49–4:29 AM and 8:17–9:18 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	9624 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 1:53 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

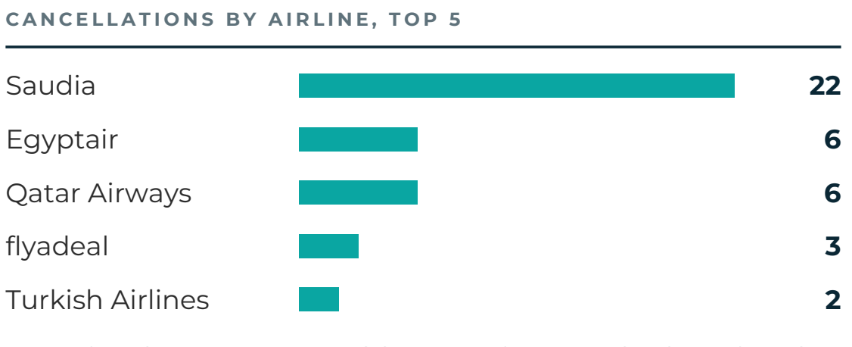
43	1:42 PM	1:46 PM	3	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
22 departures + 21 arrivals, 20% of 218 scheduled.	4P3 to Jeddah, 12 min before 1:53 PM.	F3458 from Bisha, 7 min before 1:53 PM.	3 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 1:53 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 43 at 1:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

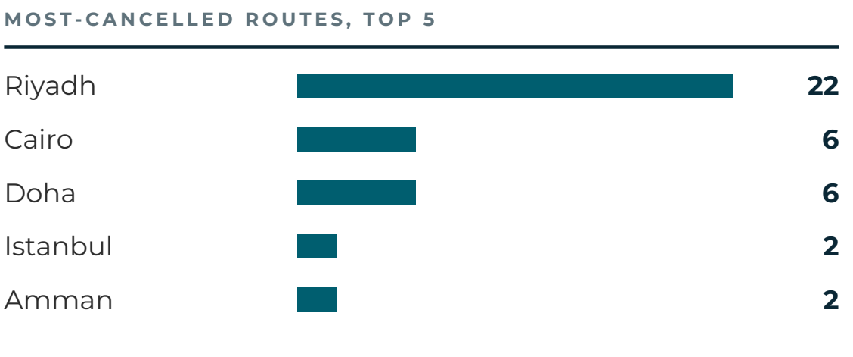
FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**22**	**21**	**43**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**22 (20%)**	**21 (19%)**	**43**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**16 (14%)**	**13 (12%)**	**29**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**13 (45%)**	**21 (62%)**	**34**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**21 min**	**6 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**25 of 56**	**28 of 56**	**53 of 112**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**0**	**0**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**1**	**4**	**5**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**15**	**14**	**29**	FR24 stats panel

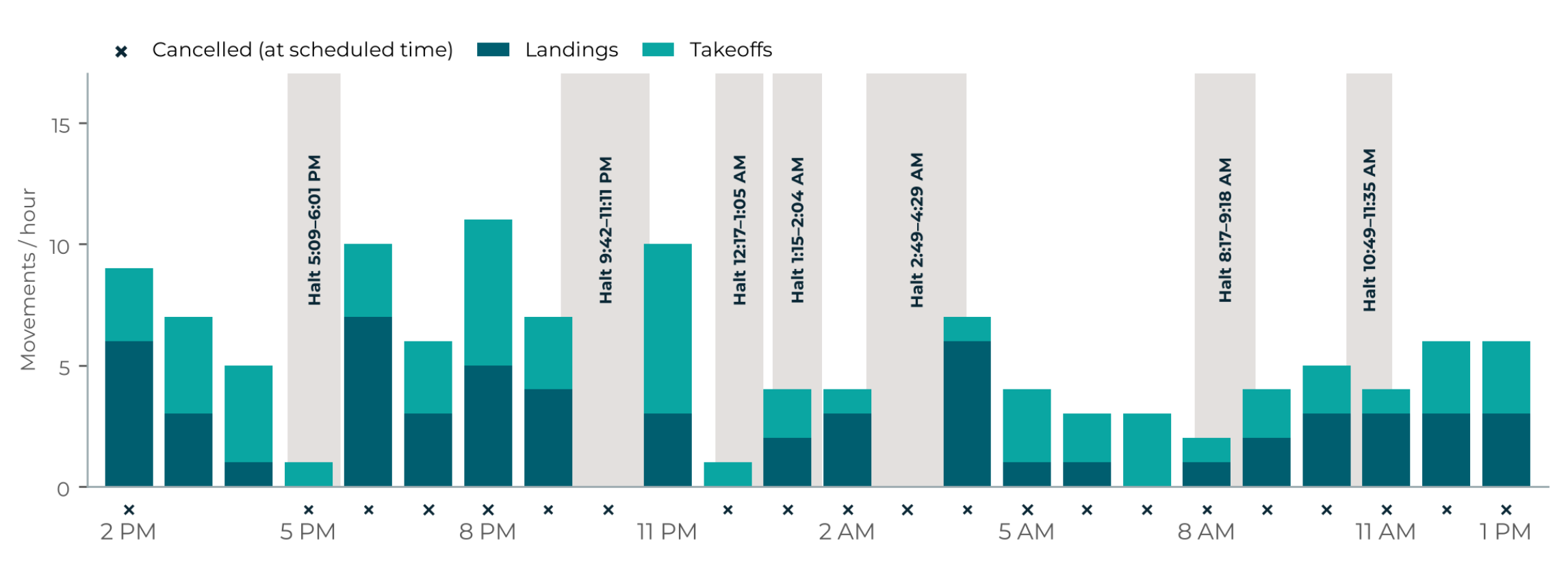
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5



MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5



TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (59) and landings (60) at DMM per hour from 2:00 PM Saturday to 1:53 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving: 3 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour. Latest halt 10:49 to 11:35 AM (46 min).

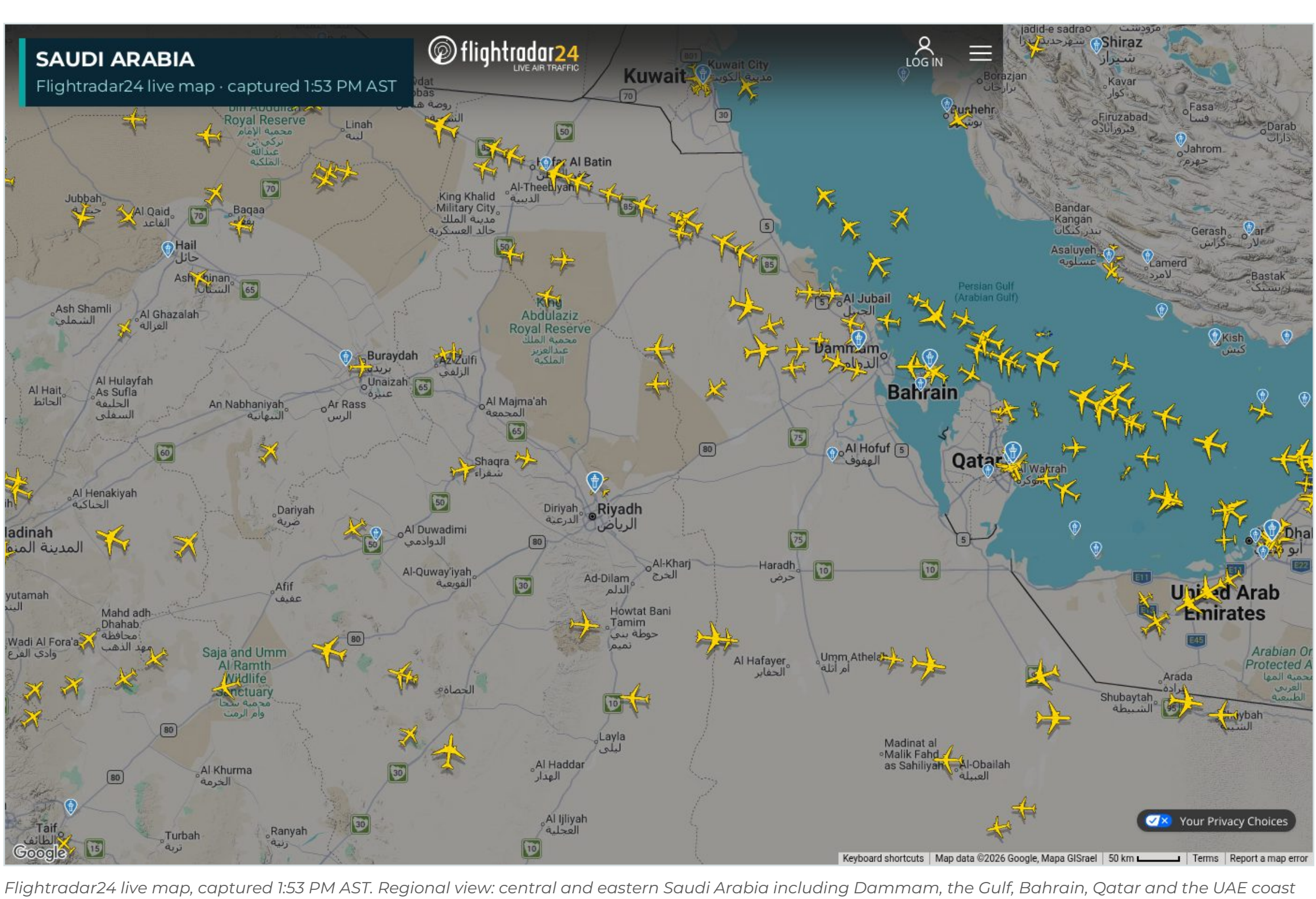
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 10:49–11:35 AM	46 min
Halt 8:17–9:18 AM	61 min
Halt 2:49–4:29 AM	100 min
Halt 1:15–2:04 AM	49 min
Halt 12:17–1:05 AM	48 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (1:55 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 1:53 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

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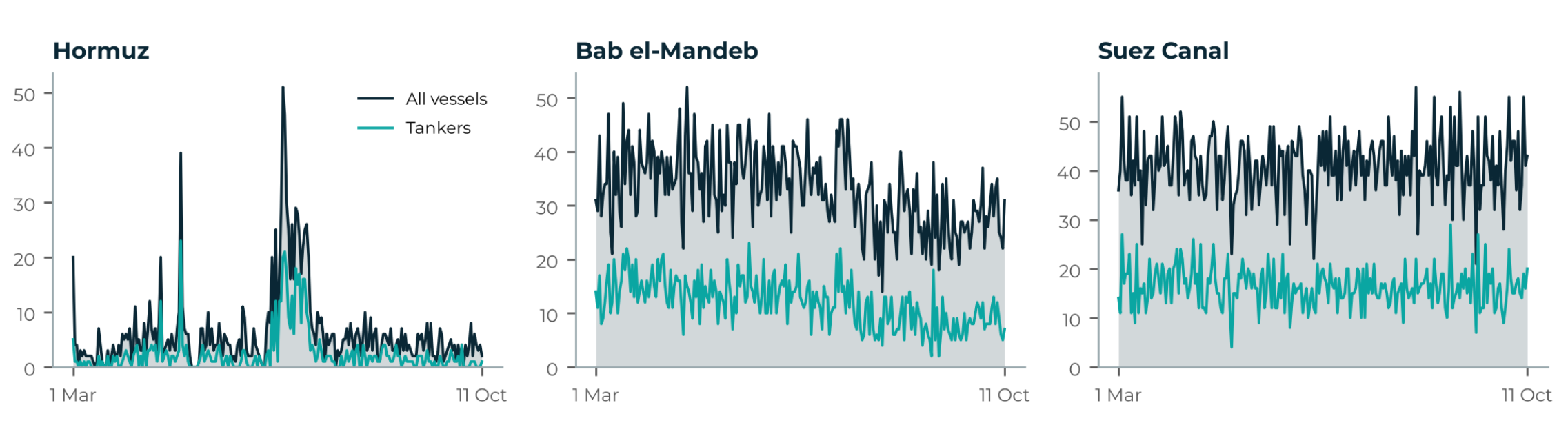
ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

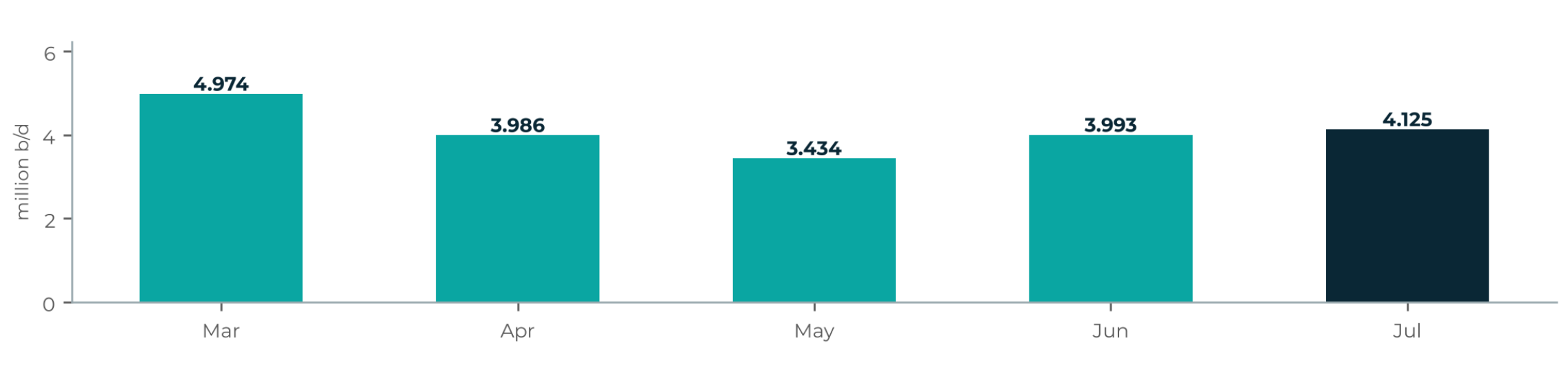
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 1:54 PM, Sun 18 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

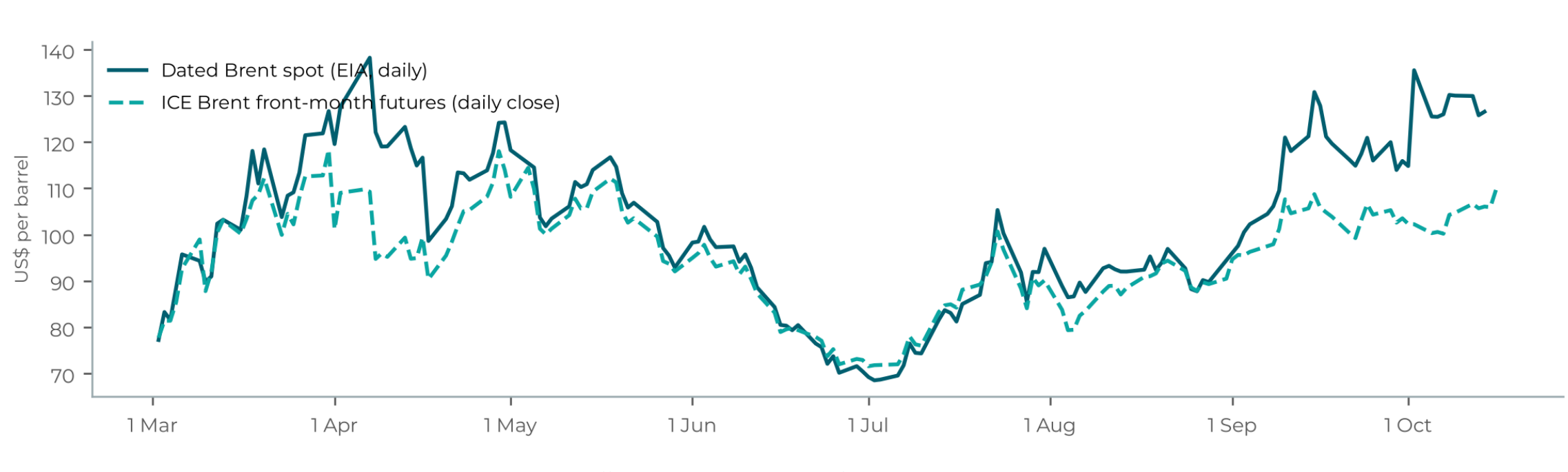


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

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METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 1:53 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
1:53 PM, Sun 18 Oct	1:53 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	3:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 PM